

Mother
By Ruby Gsanger

my mother
the dinner table
her eyes glaze
dulled by predictability
wound tightly like clockwork
'i'll just pick off what you're having'
she gestures to my father and i
with a discontented smile on her face

my mother
a vulture
condemned to a life where she doesn't choose
she plucks
she digs
she reaps the harvest of indenture

my mother
a songbird whistling a faint tune
from memories long ago
a spry thing
wings stretch wide
ready to fly to the farthest horizons
and see life at large
no duties
other than to catch wind
under her strong, capable feathers
and fly as high as she could

my mother
whose wings are long since clipped
forced to wander
looking for scraps

my mother
a vulture
but i know it wasn't always that way

before my mother
was my mother

she was a bird
much different than a vulture

but i clipped her wings

i took her song
and replaced it with talons
and a grotesque beak
and tied her to the ground
her voluntary arrest
in a luxurious cage

i took her freedom
i called her 'mother'

